Modernization in Healthcare

A vision for improving service delivery while cutting costs

CMS has an opportunity to improve healthcare service delivery, enhance interoperability, and streamline change management processes, ultimately leading to better patient outcomes and reduced costs within the U.S. healthcare system.

Multi-channel data collection, agency wide reporting, and AI-powered change management will support CMS's modernization efforts and foster a patient-centered, technology-enabled healthcare ecosystem.

CMS
CENTERS FOR MEDICARE & MEDICAID SERVICES

A Modern Approach to Service Delivery

The Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services (CMS), the world's premier insurance payor, operates on an unparalleled scale. As the largest processor of healthcare claims globally, CMS is the "big engine" of the healthcare system. With more than 6,000 employees overseeing 1.5 million healthcare providers—every clinician in the country is registered in Medicare. Major payors, hospitals, and health systems leverage the Qualtrics team to understand and optimize the full patient journey across all touchpoints, including CMS regulatory surveys. Similarly, major payors utilize the Qualtrics team to enhance the beneficiary experience at every interaction, including CAHPS and Star Ratings. Despite CMS's immense scale and impact overshadowing these private sector organizations, it currently relies on fragmented, siloed experience management solutions at the office, group, or division level. Like innovative providers and payers, CMS can leverage this future-focused, experience-driven data modernization approach to unify operational and experiential data across Medicare, Medicaid, and ACA programs—enabling real-time insights into beneficiary needs, provider performance, and service gaps. By embedding intelligent feedback loops and automation into its digital infrastructure, CMS can accelerate responsiveness, improve health equity outcomes, and drive continuous improvement aligned with its modernization roadmap.

Interoperability Across Your Technology Ecosystem

Beyond patient and beneficiary experiences, the Qualtrics team can also gather critical feedback on internal operations, including developer tools, interoperability initiatives, new software implementations, existing software utilization, usage patterns, and training and enablement programs. Additionally, the Qualtrics team boasts robust interoperability with major systems like EHRs, Salesforce, and ServiceNow, along with over 100 other out-of-the-box connectors, ensuring seamless integration within CMS's existing amalgamation of technological tools.

Drive Successful Change Management

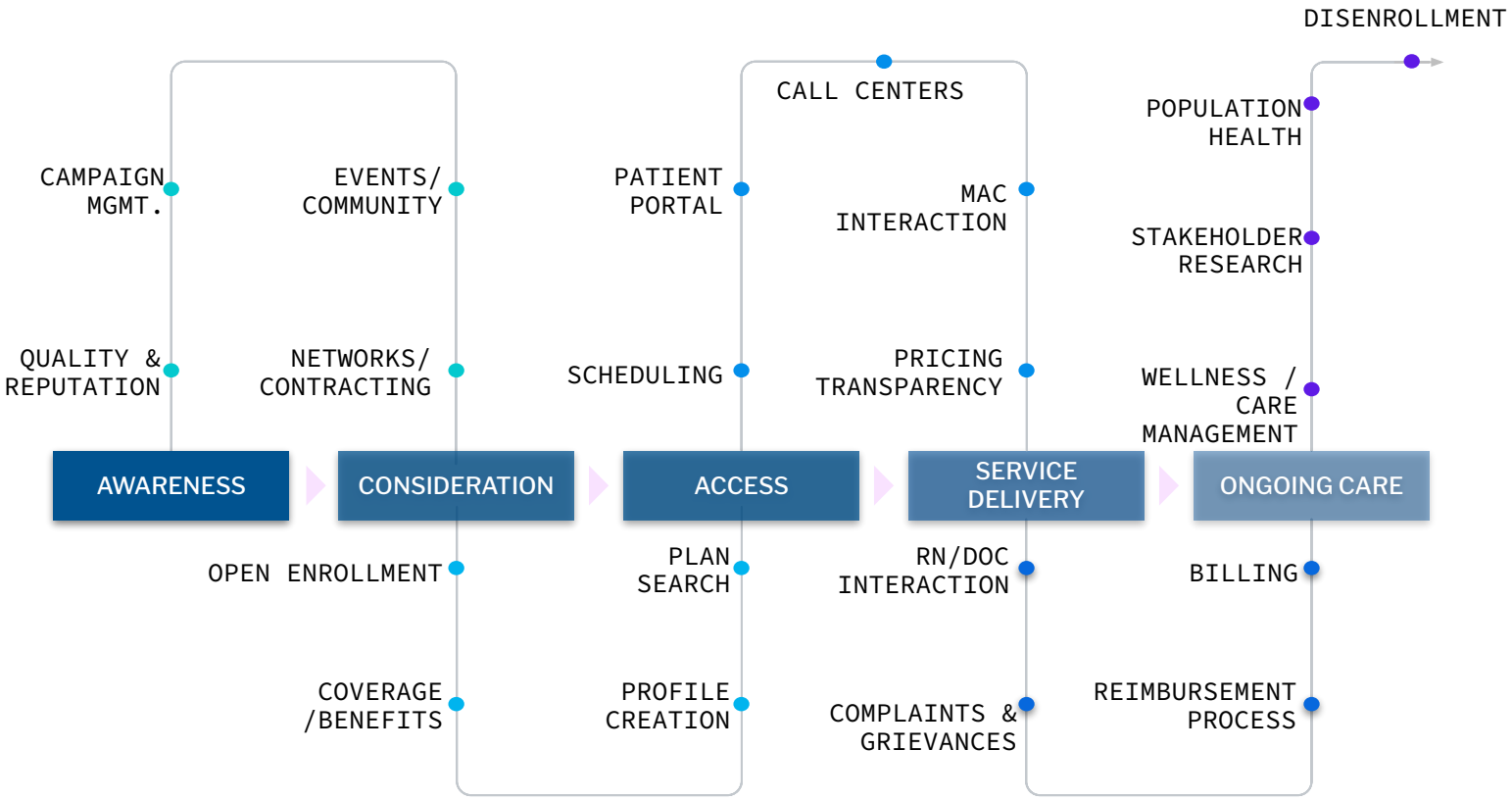
To advance CMS' data and systems modernization, we propose a Phase 2 initiative following the June 16th Healthcare Ecosystem RFI deadline, anchored in a change management approach that integrates agile principles, customer experience (CX), and design thinking. This phase would focus on confidential engagement with key stakeholders—including RFI respondents, CMS employees, contractors, providers, Medicare Administrative Contractors (MACs), and Quality Improvement Organizations (QIOs)—to gather actionable insights that were limited in the public Phase 1 response.

Using secure, role-specific surveys, we will capture the lived experiences, unmet needs, and systemic pain points of those embedded in CMS programs. This feedback becomes the foundation for iterative, stakeholder-informed change, in which agile methods allow for rapid testing and refinement, design thinking surfaces human-centered solutions, and CX principles ensure measurable improvements in both internal and external service delivery.

This integrated change management framework not only accelerates modernization efforts but also increases adoption, reduces resistance, and aligns CMS's transformation with real-world user needs. Our team is fully equipped to launch this effort without additional investment, seamlessly exporting data into CMS' data lake or visualizing it through cloud-based dashboards. The insights gained will guide responsive policymaking, optimize workflows, and drive a more adaptive and equitable healthcare ecosystem.

The world's leading consumer brands collect, analyze, report, and act on insights from all touchpoints in a single platform

Connect, analyze, and automate on data from patients, providers, beneficiaries, employees, contractors, and citizens across agency wide touchpoints



Cost is much lower when consolidating tools and firms

Qualtrics drives efficiency and improved service delivery across the agency

DIGITAL EXPERIENCE

Collect insights and feedback via app, website, and portal intercepts. Route insights to real time, role based dashboards to drive change management.

POST INTERACTION SURVEYS

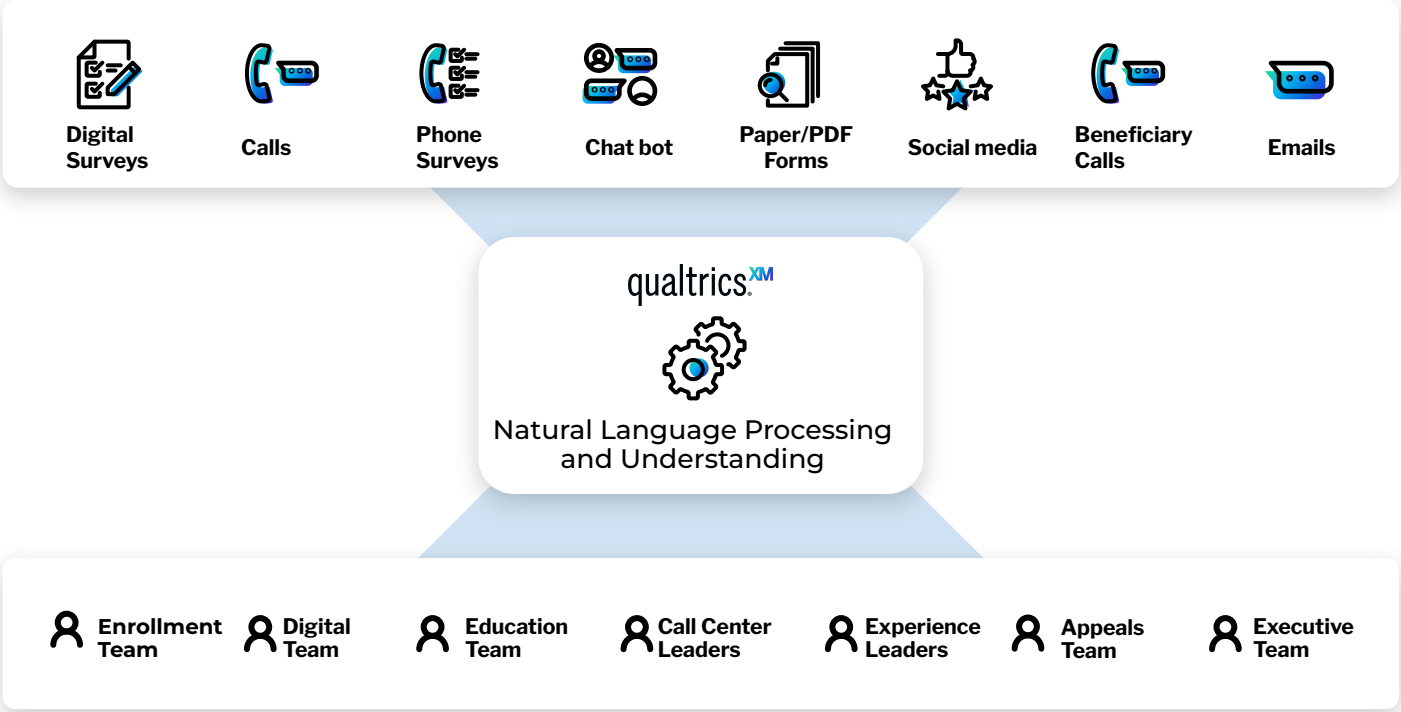
Gather insights via proactive surveys after any stakeholder touchpoint with CMS.

POST CALL ANALYTICS

Run AI & natural language processing at the sentence level of 100% of calls between CSRs and beneficiaries and providers. Understand the call reasons, situation, effort, emotion, and intensity of the callers and CSRs.

AUTOMATED QUALITY MANAGEMENT

Quantify and score CSRs on the presence of desired behaviors and the absence of undesired behaviors.



Executive view of consumer experience across calls, websites, portals, chats, emails

Track and drive increased customer satisfaction, customer effort, customer trust scores

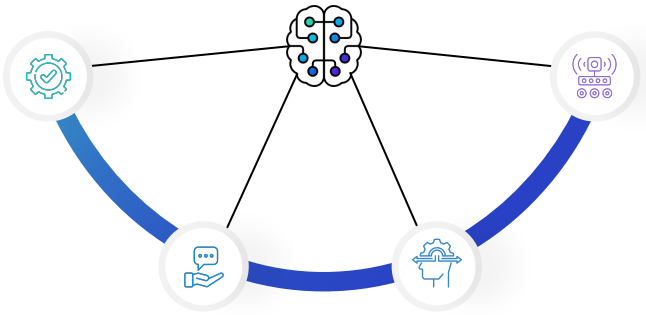
Decrease costly and redundant consulting and technology contracts aimed at understanding the voice of the stakeholder

Optimize change management (refine IVR, education, outreach, service quality, enrollment, trust)

Optimize staffing levels for call center agents and QA analysts to improve efficiency.

Increase digital deflection (decrease number of calls)

Break down organizational silos and drive cost savings across CMS through wall-to-wall data collection, automation, and action on a single platform.



Beneficiaries

AI insights from 100% of calls, chats, emails, & solicited feedback in every call center

Employees

Gather frontline insights from employees and contractors for workforce and tech stack optimization

Providers

Collect, automate, and act on all healthcare provider and insurance provider insights. Expand Qualtrics listening across every touchpoint a provider has with CMS.

Citizens

Listen to and act on citizen experiences across each touchpoint with CMS

Qualtrics supports interoperability with out of the box connectors and open APIs

Understand experiences at all touchpoints.

Import **real-time profile and transaction data** to drive feedback capture

Ingest **conversational data** sources (calls, chats, etc.) for analysis

Facilitate **distribution** of survey-based feedback capture at key moments

qualtrics XM

Real-Time Feedback to Action Loop

Drive action and automation at key moments.

Drive action through alerts, **workflows,** and native integrations

Enrich patient **profiles** based on prior feedback and sentiment

Perform **service recovery** by automating the right action at the right time

Dozens of out-of-the-box connectors, native pre-built integrations, and robust APIs.

FROM THE RFI

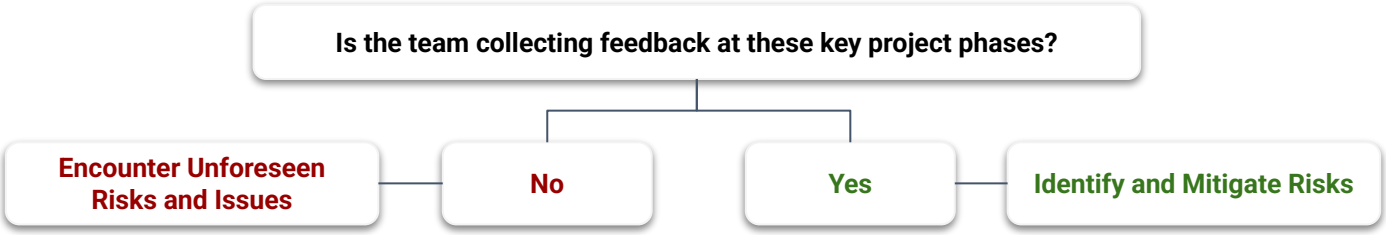
"The agency, in partnership with ASTP/ONC, is **seeking public input on how best to advance a seamless, secure, and patient-centered digital health infrastructure."**

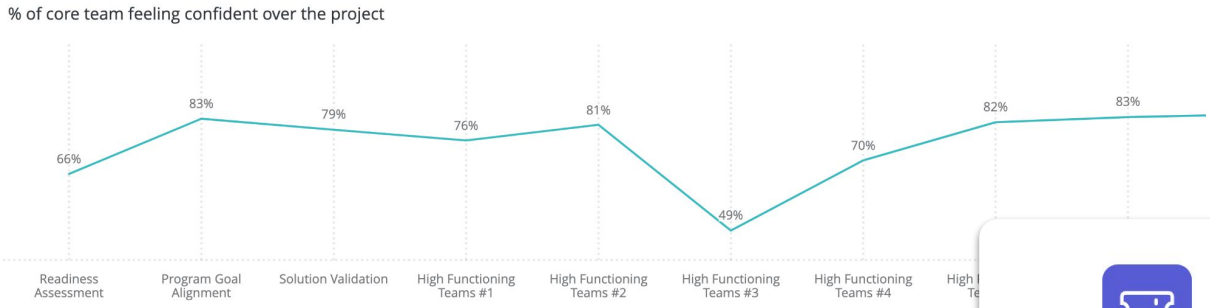
Qualtrics is the leading platform for collecting and analyzing feedback throughout all the phases of technology modernization

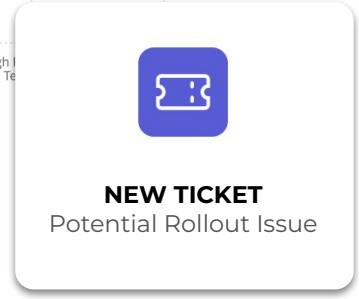
	RESEARCH	DESIGN/BUILD/PROCURE/TEST	DEPLOY (REPEAT)
IMPACT	Capture the confidential **needs and perceptions of all stakeholders** (providers, patients, payors, etc) at scale to shape the future healthcare	Test, validate, and refine solutions based on **end-user feedback** to align with user needs, reduce risk, and increase adoption.	**Continuously measure stakeholder experiences** across all channels with our digital health infrastructure.
FEATURES	Survey Research Panel Procurement Focus Groups User Interviews Existing CMS Qualtrics data	Survey Research Prototype Testing (UX) IT Team Feedback Training Feedback	Embedded Web/App Surveys Digital Behavior Analysis Transactional Feedback Call Center Help/Desk Analysis

Drive successful change management by providing project stakeholders an avenue to share requirements and feedback

At key milestones, pulse **project team members** - including service delivery leaders, UX designers, developers, testers, trainers, trainees, and more.







Proactively identify project risks based on stakeholder feedback, helping project leaders re-align scope, timelines, and resources to increase project success.

Call to Action

Qualtrics and their partners will help CMS with an action plan using Qualtrics feedback, data, and insights

In response to the questions raised by CMS's RFI, we are pleased to share information and recommendations grounded in its experience partnering with government agencies and the private sector to successfully modernize IT – driving value and building a better user experience.

We prepare the organization for successful implementation by combining data-driven insights through Qualtrics tools, stakeholder engagement, and agile planning. Key activities include:

- **Insight Generation**: Leveraging AI-enabled analytics and geospatial tools to uncover experience drivers and identify disparities across populations and locations.
- **Strategic Alignment**: Translate insights into actionable priorities **that align with the agency mission.**
- **Process and Policy Modernization**: Apply human-centered design to reengineer workflows and identify policy or regulatory barriers to modernization.
- **Agile Implementation Planning**: Build adaptable roadmaps and success criteria, enabling early wins through iterative development led by change agents and product teams.
- **Experience Integration**: Apply fully integrated design thinking approach that aligns all parts of the agency to drive accelerated outcomes and scalable impact to ensure stakeholders needs are identified, creating efficiencies before spending

Communication

Armed with a well-structured strategic communication approach, CMS leaders can communicate with a unified message to ensure stakeholders are equipped to move in the agreed upon direction.

Core elements of our partners' strategic communication approach include:

- **Addressing Barriers** early by proactively managing perceptions and readiness for change.
- **Shaping Positive Narratives** through targeted messaging that builds momentum and influences key decision-makers.
- **Reinforcing Success** via consistent "sustain the gains" communication to maintain support and credibility.
- **Promoting Shared Outcomes** that highlight collective wins and measurable progress.
- **Creating a Governance Structure** to coordinate communication across levels, activate change champions, and ensure message consistency across partner networks.

System of action

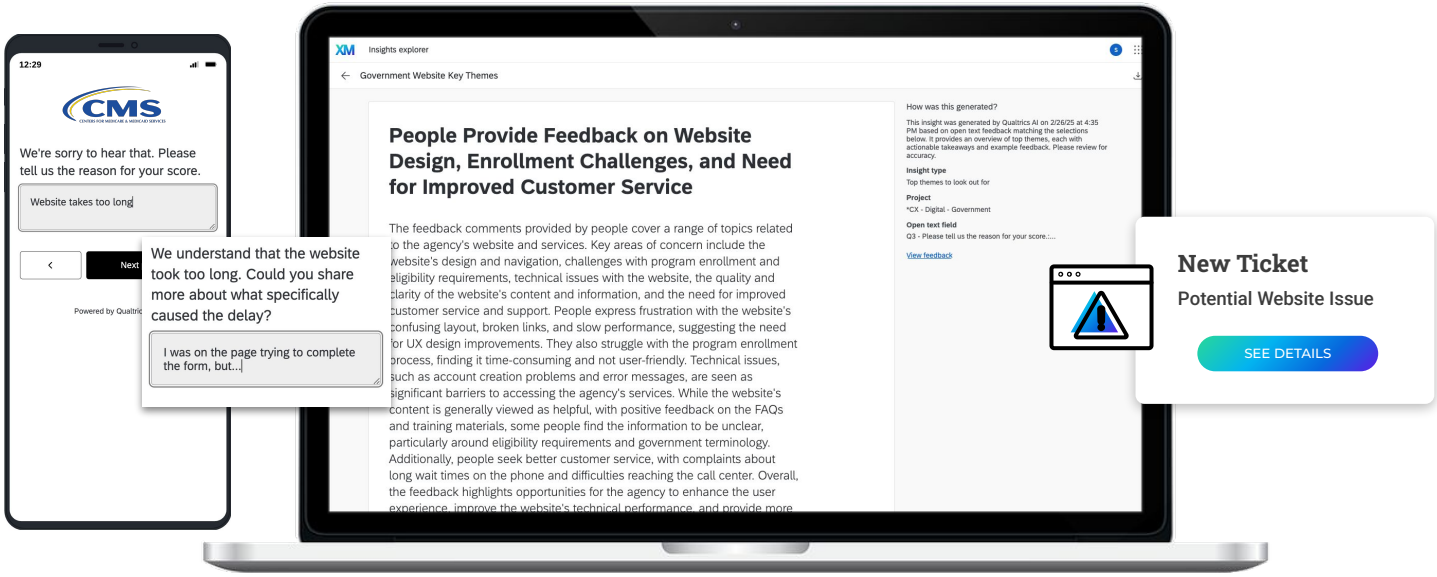
CMS will now be prepared to transition strategic planning into action by aligning modernized IT systems with redesigned policies and business processes. The goal is to deliver measurable outcomes through structured execution and agile delivery.

Key activities include:

- **Identify** process, policy, and technology interdependencies
- **Translating Goals** into Actionable Initiatives
- **Defining Clear Ownership** by assigning roles and responsibilities to drive accountability.
- **Applying Agile Sprints** to pilot efforts, promoting transparency and rapid iteration.
- **Establishing Success Criteria** and Accountability Frameworks to guide implementation and measure progress.
- **Tracking Impact and Insights** through Qualtrics tools, tracking behavioral analytics and digital insights, to quantify performance outcomes from initiation through delivery.

This structured yet flexible approach ensures CMS can modernize IT in a way that is user-centered, scalable, and outcome-driven.

Leverage AI & technology automation to remove manual effort & streamline data collection and analysis efforts.



With **Qualtrics AI and embedded workflows**, teams can drive outcomes from data faster than ever before, reducing manual burden and accelerating time to value.

Improve data quality with AI-powered adaptive questions.

Infuse conversational follow-ups within data collection activities, helping teams capture higher-quality data and insights the first time.

Synthesize qualitative data in a matter of seconds.

Surface key themes from large sets of unstructured data in a matter of a few clicks, saving significant time compared to manual analysis.

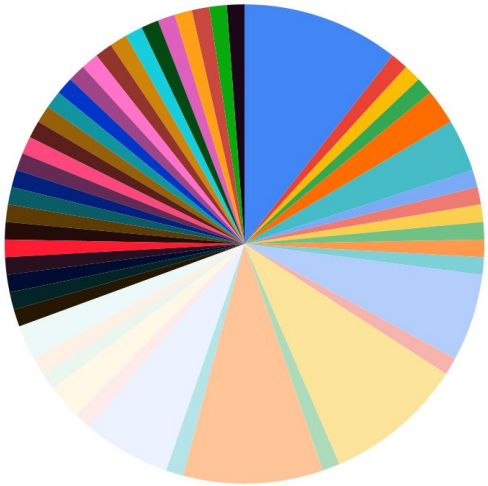
Ask questions of data, conversationally.

Reduce the barrier of statistical expertise to generate insights, allowing users to get to findings faster and through a simple conversational interface.

Streamline action-taking with automated workflows.

Automatically route prioritized areas of opportunity to the right teams through point-and-click workflows, ticketing, and native integrations with key CMS systems.

CMS uses many redundant firms to gather siloed insights



There are **86 unique contracts** for Marketing Research, Public Opinion Polling, and Research and Development in the Social Sciences and Humanities

CMS can save millions of dollars via consolidating redundant firms whose work can be accomplished with modern technology

Current Marketing Research and Public Opinion Polling Costs*

$56M in current cost

$492M in option year cost

Current Research and Development in the Social Sciences and Humanities Costs*

$739M in current cost

$1.9B in option year cost

Qualtrics could replace 10-20% of the above contracts at a fraction of the cost

*Data from fedmine a gov spend solution

Leading organizations trust Qualtrics

3M
FRONTLINE USERS

2B
CONVERSATIONS ANALYZED

2X
LEADER IN IDC ANALYST REPORTS

#1
XM PLATFORM

20,000
CUSTOMERS

100+
COUNTRIES AROUND THE WORLD USE QUALTRICS